

TriageAI

SMS/USSD symptom triage, clinic routing, and blood-panel risk screening

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The Problem

Millions of people die annually from cancers that are highly treatable when caught early, yet roughly half the world's population lacks access to basic diagnostic services (WHO).

In low-connectivity and low-income regions, patients often have no accessible way to determine whether a symptom warrants urgent care, and existing blood test results are frequently filed without being reviewed for early risk markers due to clinician time pressure. TriageAI addresses both the front-door triage gap and the underused-data gap.

How It Works

- SMS/USSD gateway enables symptom intake with zero smartphone or data requirement.
- Rule-based classifier maps reported symptoms to an urgency tier and routes to the nearest capable clinic.
- Premium blood-panel module compares patient-entered marker values against established clinical reference ranges and flags out-of-range results for specialist follow-up.
- All risk-flag outputs are explicitly labeled as a screening aid, never a diagnosis — by design, to remain outside full medical-device regulatory classification while still delivering real triage value.

Core Data Model

- Patient — Anonymized or consented patient profile and contact channel.
- SymptomReport — Reported symptoms, urgency classification, timestamp.
- ClinicDirectory — Verified clinic locations, capacity, contact details.
- BloodPanelUpload — Patient-entered blood marker values (CBC, PSA, CEA, CA-125, AFP, etc.).
- RiskFlag — Rule-based/ML-assisted flag against reference ranges, always paired with a specialist-referral disclaimer.

Security, Privacy & Compliance

- Health data encrypted at rest and in transit; access scoped strictly to the reporting patient and their nominated clinic.
- No blood-panel data used for anything beyond generating the immediate risk-flag output — no secondary use without explicit consent.
- Clear regulatory positioning as clinical decision support / screening aid, distinct from a diagnostic medical device, to align with a realistic and lawful path to market.

Market Opportunity & Funder Fit

Digital health market in Sub-Saharan Africa projected to reach \$3.5B by 2030.
Target beachhead: rural primary health centres lacking specialist access.

Strong fit for global health innovation funding: Gates Foundation Global Health Discovery, WHO digital health initiatives, EU Horizon Europe Health cluster, and national ministry of health digital triage programs.

The Ask

\$180,000 grant to deploy SMS/USSD triage across 100 rural clinics + blood-panel screening pilot, 12 months.

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